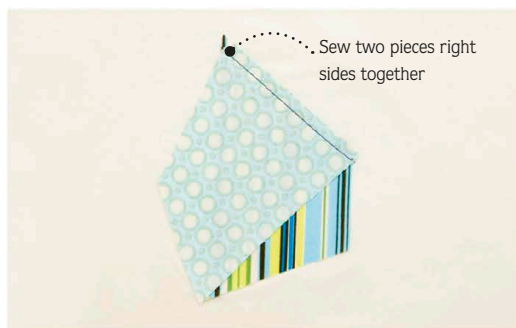


▶ WORKING ON A FOUNDATION

Several patchwork techniques are worked on a foundation, also known as stitch-and-flip. Crazy patchwork uses random shapes and is a great way to use up scraps. It is best made on a lightweight foundation fabric, such as calico. Reverse-pieced

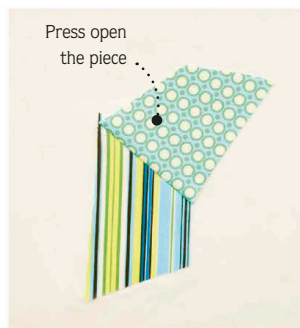
foundation piecing ensures accuracy and is a quick way to make blocks. You can make patterns for each segment, or cut the shapes with generous seam allowances.

FOUNDATION PIECING: TOP PIECED

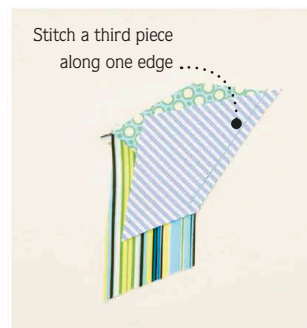


1 Cut a foundation of lightweight calico the size you want the finished block to be plus a 2.5cm (1in) seam allowance all around.

2 Gather a selection of straight-sided pieces of various shapes and colours. Starting in the centre, place two pieces right sides together, on top of the foundation, and sew along one side through all three layers. Take a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam allowance, whether you are working by hand or machine.



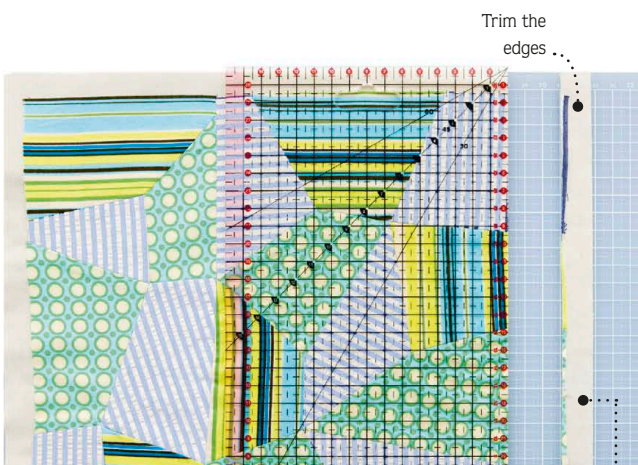
3 Press or fingerpress the pieces open.



4 Add piece 3 along one edge of the combined shape made in Step 1. Open and press. If necessary, trim the seam allowance level with scissors before you add the next piece. Snip off the thread ends.



5 Continue clockwise around the centre piece until the foundation is completely filled. Keep the arrangement random and avoid parallel lines. Run the seams in different directions and vary the angles. Press each piece open as you work.



6 Trim the edges level with the edges of the foundation fabric. Embellish the finished piece if you wish.